Westbrook City Council

~ Special Meeting ~

Date: Monday, May 18, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1193414291
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_05182026-1007

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Mayor's Message: Suboxone Administration & Recovery Support Initiative

EMS Opioid-Overdose Pilot Program (MOUD Initiative) [4:32]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse opened with a Memorial Day reminder (parade and Riverbank Park ceremony, Monday, May 25), then introduced Fire Chief Stephen Sloan to present a new EMS pilot program administering buprenorphine (Suboxone) in the field following an overdose — the "MOUD" (Medication for Opioid Use Disorder) initiative.

Chief Sloan reported Westbrook is currently the only fire department in Maine approved for this pilot (five other agencies — United Ambulance, Redington-Fairview Hospital, Portland, Biddeford Fire, and Waterville Fire — may enroll later, with Westbrook as the lead/data site over the pilot's 36-month run). 2025 Westbrook data: 59 overdoses (just under 3% of the statewide total); 24 patients transported, 35 refused care; naloxone administered to 17 who then refused further care; 22 fatal overdoses recorded in EMS run data, two of them in Westbrook; police responded to four additional overdoses that didn't require EMS. Maine is near the worst in the nation for overdose rate per 100,000 residents — only West Virginia is worse. Without intervention, Sloan projected the City could lose roughly 6–10 residents to overdose over the pilot's 3-year span.

Program goals: 15% of contacted overdose patients engaged in a treatment program, 55–65% linked to definitive care, under 2% adverse-event rate. Follow-up protocol: a fire department team member contacts the patient within 24 hours; the police department's recovery liaison follows up within 48 hours; the patient is linked to Maine Health's Comprehensive Addiction Medicine Center within 72 hours. Cost: already budgeted, roughly $1,000/year for medication.

Several councilors expressed strong support, citing personal/family experience with overdose loss. Councilor Chau asked about liability for administering the wrong drug; Sloan said the greater liability risk is actually in allowing a patient to refuse care untreated, and that buprenorphine is a low-risk medication. City Clerk Ledoux then gave a brief absentee-voting update ahead of the June 9 state primary/school budget referendum.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items
None.

Orders of the Day — Second & Final Reading

Orders 2026-57, -58, -59 — Public Safety Feasibility Study, Gas Meters & Saco St. MPI Agreement (Consent) [25:58]

Discussion Summary
All three first-read at the May 4, 2026 meeting: the $47,286 Port City Architects Public Safety Building feasibility study update, the $21,512.20 Fire Department gas meter replacement (offset by a $7,817 PNGTS grant), and the MaineDOT Municipal Partnership Initiative agreement for Saco Street roadway improvements (up to $750,000 in state reimbursement) — see that meeting's summary for full detail. Moved together by Councilor Rairdon.

Key Decisions
✓ Passed together by unanimous roll call, 7–0.

Action Items
None.

New Business — Resolves (One Reading Required)

Resolve 2026-12 — Memorial Day Parade Road Closures [27:31]

Found on page 35 of the packet.

Discussion Summary
Authorizes closure of Mechanic Street (William Clark Drive to Main Street), Vertical Way, and Main Street (Mechanic Street to Capt. Bill Hartley Ave.), 9–11 AM, Monday, May 25, 2026, for the annual Memorial Day Parade.

Key Decisions
✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0.

Action Items
None.

Resolve 2026-13 — Overnight Spring Street Closure for Water Utility Work [28:55]

Found on page 37 of the packet.

Discussion Summary
Authorizes an overnight closure of Spring Street (Thomas Drive to the South Portland municipal boundary), 7 PM–7 AM, for a water-main connection to a residential project at 984 Spring Street. Representatives from Procopio Companies (developer) and Sargent Corporation (contractor) explained a three-day plan: a daytime single-lane closure to prepare the site (Tuesday, May 26), the full overnight closure for excavation and tie-in (Wednesday, May 27), and a final daytime single-lane closure to repave (Thursday, May 28) — rain or shine. Councilor Rairdon questioned the planned police staging point, suggesting officers positioned farther up at the County Road traffic light might be safer; Assistant City Administrator Franceschi relayed that Police Captain

Goldberg had determined the Spiller Drive/Thomas Drive staging was actually safer, keeping officers out of the signalized intersection given low overnight traffic volume.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0.

Action Items

None.

New Business — Orders (One Reading Required)

Order 2026-60 — Westbrook Together Days — Mass Gathering Permit & Street Closures [36:58]

Found on page 52 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Approves the Mass Gathering Permit (Major) and street closures (Main St., Bridge St., Mayberry St., Lincoln St., 9–11 AM Saturday) for the annual Westbrook Together Days event, June 5–6, 2026. Councilor Chau thanked longtime volunteer organizer Sue Joyce (also behind Halloween events and the Main Street tree lighting) and noted the event committee needs more volunteers.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0.

Action Items

None.

New Business — Orders (First Reading, Two Readings Required)

Order 2026-61 — Davan Indoor Pool — Emergency Motor Repair Confirmation

[39:19]

Found on page 57 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Confirms, after the fact, a Mayor's-emergency-authority expenditure of $8,348.30 to Christman Pool Service for a replacement motor at the Davan Indoor Pool (Westbrook Community Center). Director Greg Post's team caught early corrosion/leak signs in the 12-year-old motor before failure; the City's last full motor failure, in 2014, flooded the Community Center basement with five feet of standing water.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-62 — Fire Department Donation Acceptance & Supply Hose Purchase

[42:43]

Found on page 64 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Accepts a $5,000 donation from the American Online Giving Foundation (via Enbridge's “Safe Community First Responder” grant program) and authorizes a $6,850 purchase of five 100' large-diameter supply hoses from Harrison Shrader Enterprises, filling a gap between this year's and next year's capital planning for hose replacement.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-63 — Pyxis Medication-Storage Rental Agreement [45:10]

Found on page 68 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes a five-year, $11,172/year rental agreement with CareFusion Solutions for a BD Pyxis MedStation and supply tower, funded from opioid settlement funds. This responds to a 2017 DEA rule now being enforced: as of July 14, 2026, hospitals will no longer supply the Fire Department's controlled medications (fentanyl, Versed/midazolam, ketamine), requiring the Department to obtain its own DEA license and securely store/dispense them in-house. Council Q&A covered security (biometric scan plus unique passcode, dual-provider verification required to dispense, a daily tamper-seal check at shift change, only three chiefs authorized to restock, a 3-vial-per-call dispensing cap) and the rent-vs-buy rationale (the ~60-day compliance deadline favored renting now, with a possible switch to outright purchase in a future year once the Department's auditing processes are proven out).

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-64 — Westbrook Trail Blazes — Trail Grooming Equipment Funding

[56:52]

Found on page 82 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes a $30,000 Recreation & Conservation Commission expenditure to the Westbrook Trail Blazes snowmobile club for trail-grooming equipment (a Polaris Ranger and track system, retail value over $40,000). Club president Dan McCarthy described the club's 18-year partnership with the City, 30+ miles of multi-use trails (also used by hikers, bikers, and cross-country skiers), and roughly 1,000 volunteer hours this year alone. Councilors McCambridge and Chau both praised the club at length.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 7–0 (first reading). Second and final reading is scheduled for the June 1, 2026 meeting.

Action Items

None.

Second Public Comment

Blood Drive Announcement & E-Bike Nighttime Glare Safety Concern [1:03:23]

Discussion Summary

Dennis Maraud (41 Falmouth St.), a member of the Stephen Manchester American Legion Post, announced an upcoming Red Cross blood drive (Friday, June 12, 9 AM–2 PM, at the Post next to Riverbank Park) and a second drive planned for October 9. Speaking separately as a member of the Westbrook Safe Mobility Access Committee, he raised a nighttime safety concern about e-bikes and electric scooters with bright headlights blinding oncoming drivers, describing a recent incident at the Forest Street/Main Street intersection where his windshield was briefly whited out by oncoming e-bike headlights.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

Closing

Referrals, Committee Reports & Adjournment [1:08:03]

Discussion Summary

No referrals, no committee report updates, and no executive session. Meeting adjourned by unanimous roll call.

Key Decisions

✓ Motion to adjourn passed, 7–0.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names and figures against the official packet and the city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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